

Logical Positivism — MCQ Solutions

Option-specific explanations and examiner traps

Open only after attempting the corresponding question. Each solution explains every option, identifies the examiner trap, gives a repair action, maps coverage and links the relevant PYQ demand.

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MCQ 1

Which description correctly identifies the 1929 Vienna Circle manifesto?

A. Schlick alone authored the manifesto as the Circle's binding verificationist creed. B. Ayer issued the manifesto in Britain after publishing *Language, Truth and Logic*. C. Hahn, Neurath and Carnap wrote the manifesto and dedicated it to Moritz Schlick. D. Wittgenstein and Popper jointly issued the manifesto as a programme of falsification.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Schlick alone authored the manifesto as the Circle's binding verificationist creed." Correct doctrine: Schlick led the Circle but did not author the manifesto, which did not impose one frozen criterion. Correct replacement: "Hahn, Neurath and Carnap wrote the manifesto and dedicated it to Moritz Schlick." - **B:** False proposition: "Ayer issued the manifesto in Britain after publishing *Language, Truth and Logic*." Correct doctrine: Ayer's 1936 book popularised the movement in English; it was not the 1929 manifesto. Correct replacement: "Hahn, Neurath and Carnap wrote the manifesto and dedicated it to Moritz Schlick." - **C:** The manifesto was a collective scientific-worldview statement by Hahn, Neurath and Carnap, dedicated to Schlick. - **D:** False proposition: "Wittgenstein and Popper jointly issued the manifesto as a programme of falsification." Correct doctrine: Neither was a Circle member, and falsifiability is Popper's distinct proposal. Correct replacement: "Hahn, Neurath and Carnap wrote the manifesto and dedicated it to Moritz Schlick."

Examiner trap 1: Confusing leadership, authorship and later popularisation.

Repair action: Attach 1929 to Hahn–Neurath–Carnap, dedicated to Schlick.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(c); historical frame.

MCQ 2

Which membership and influence statement is accurate?

A. Schlick, Carnap and Neurath were central Circle figures, and Ayer and Wittgenstein were influential non-members. B. Ayer founded the Vienna Circle, while Schlick later introduced its programme to Britain. C. Wittgenstein chaired the Circle and co-authored its scientific-worldview manifesto. D. Popper and Quine were Circle members who progressively weakened the verification principle.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** This preserves the difference between institutional membership, intellectual influence and English transmission. - **B:** False proposition: "Ayer founded the Vienna Circle, while Schlick later introduced its programme to Britain." Correct doctrine: Schlick led the Vienna group; Ayer later transmitted its ideas to an English audience. Correct replacement: "Schlick, Carnap and Neurath were central Circle figures, and Ayer and Wittgenstein were influential non-members." - **C:** False proposition: "Wittgenstein chaired the Circle and co-authored its scientific-worldview manifesto." Correct doctrine: He

conversed with Schlick and Waismann but never joined or chaired the Circle. Correct replacement: "Schlick, Carnap and Neurath were central Circle figures, and Ayer and Wittgenstein were influential non-members."
- **D:** False proposition: "Popper and Quine were Circle members who progressively weakened the verification principle." Correct doctrine: They are critics or successors, not members whose views count as internal formulations. Correct replacement: "Schlick, Carnap and Neurath were central Circle figures, and Ayer and Wittgenstein were influential non-members."

Examiner trap 2: Treating every associated philosopher as a Circle member.

Repair action: Separate core members, influences, popularisers and critics.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: All PYQs; provenance.

MCQ 3

To call philosophy a 'handmaid to science' in the positivist programme is primarily to assign it the task of:

A. Philosophy should collect laboratory observations overlooked by the specialist sciences. B. Philosophy should derive scientific laws from self-evident metaphysical principles. C. Philosophy should replace scientific theories with ordinary descriptions and reject formal reconstruction. D. Philosophy should clarify scientific language and logic rather than add rival factual discoveries.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Philosophy should collect laboratory observations overlooked by the specialist sciences." Correct doctrine: Data collection belongs to sciences; philosophy analyses their concepts and language. Correct replacement: "Philosophy should clarify scientific language and logic rather than add rival factual discoveries." - **B:** False proposition: "Philosophy should derive scientific laws from self-evident metaphysical principles." Correct doctrine: The movement rejected synthetic a priori foundations and speculative derivation. Correct replacement: "Philosophy should clarify scientific language and logic rather than add rival factual discoveries." - **C:** False proposition: "Philosophy should replace scientific theories with ordinary descriptions and reject formal reconstruction." Correct doctrine: Ordinary-language therapy is later, not the Circle's ideal-language programme. Correct replacement: "Philosophy should clarify scientific language and logic rather than add rival factual discoveries." - **D:** The programme redefined philosophy as logical clarification, reconstruction and removal of pseudo-problems.

Examiner trap 3: Reading 'handmaid' as subordinate empirical research.

Repair action: Use the pair: science states facts; philosophy clarifies their language.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 4

Which influence map avoids collapsing distinct sources into a single doctrine?

A. Mach supplied empiricism, Frege and Russell modern logic, Einstein an operational model, and early Wittgenstein logical-form themes. B. Mach supplied formal logic, Einstein emotivism, and Wittgenstein the strong-weak distinction. C. Russell supplied protocol coherentism, Neurath picture theory, and Schlick falsifiability. D. Kant supplied physicalism, Hegel supplied verification, and Popper supplied the analytic-synthetic distinction used by the Circle.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** The Circle combined several influences without simply reproducing any one of them. - **B:** False proposition: "Mach supplied formal logic, Einstein emotivism, and Wittgenstein the strong-weak distinction." Correct doctrine: These attributions confuse empiricism, physics, metaethics and Ayer's terminology. Correct replacement: "Mach supplied empiricism, Frege and Russell modern logic, Einstein an operational model, and early Wittgenstein logical-form themes." - **C:** False proposition: "Russell supplied protocol coherentism, Neurath picture theory, and Schlick falsifiability." Correct doctrine: Neurath defended revisable protocols, picture theory is Wittgensteinian, and falsifiability is Popperian. Correct replacement: "Mach supplied empiricism, Frege and Russell modern logic, Einstein an operational model, and early Wittgenstein logical-form themes." - **D:** False proposition: "Kant supplied physicalism, Hegel supplied verification, and Popper supplied the analytic-synthetic distinction used by the Circle." Correct doctrine: Mach contributes empiricist pressure, Frege and Russell modern logic, Einstein an operational model, and Popper a later demarcation criterion; Kant and Hegel do not supply the listed positivist doctrines. Correct replacement: "Mach supplied empiricism, Frege and Russell modern logic, Einstein an operational model, and early Wittgenstein logical-form themes."

Examiner trap 4: Remembering names while misassigning contributions.

Repair action: Build the line: empiricism–logic–relativity–Tractarian form.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 5

The verification principle first asks whether a declarative sentence:

A. A declarative sentence is meaningful only when current scientific opinion accepts it as true. B. A declarative sentence is meaningful when its grammar is elegant, its vocabulary is familiar, and ordinary speakers accept it. C. A declarative sentence is meaningful when it is analytic or open to possible empirical testing. D. A declarative sentence is meaningful when it expresses an attitude approved by most people.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "A declarative sentence is meaningful only when current scientific opinion accepts it as true." Correct doctrine: A false empirical claim can remain meaningful because observations bear on it. Correct replacement: "A declarative sentence is meaningful when it is

analytic or open to possible empirical testing.” - **B:** False proposition: “A declarative sentence is meaningful when its grammar is elegant, its vocabulary is familiar, and ordinary speakers accept it.” Correct doctrine: Surface grammar may conceal a pseudo-statement, so elegance is insufficient. Correct replacement: “A declarative sentence is meaningful when it is analytic or open to possible empirical testing.” - **C:** It is a proposed criterion of factual significance, not an immediate test of truth. - **D:** False proposition: “A declarative sentence is meaningful when it expresses an attitude approved by most people.” Correct doctrine: Approval concerns practical force, not cognitive truth-aptness. Correct replacement: “A declarative sentence is meaningful when it is analytic or open to possible empirical testing.”

Examiner trap 5: Equating meaningfulness with truth or social approval.

Repair action: Ask what could count for or against it before asking whether it is true.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 6

Why is 'The earth is flat' different from 'The Absolute is beyond every possible experience' on the positivist test?

A. The flat-earth claim is analytic, and the Absolute claim is a weakly confirmed law. B. The flat-earth claim is meaningful and false, and the Absolute claim excludes every possible empirical test. C. Modern science has empirically falsified both claims in precisely the same way. D. Both claims are meaningful because each contains a familiar grammatical subject.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: “The flat-earth claim is analytic, and the Absolute claim is a weakly confirmed law.” Correct doctrine: Flatness is contingent and the Absolute claim supplies no scientific consequences. Correct replacement: “The flat-earth claim is meaningful and false, and the Absolute claim excludes every possible empirical test.” - **B:** Possible observations settle the first claim, whereas the second is insulated from observational relevance. - **C:** False proposition: “Modern science has empirically falsified both claims in precisely the same way.” Correct doctrine: The metaphysical verdict is lack of cognitive content, not empirical falsity. Correct replacement: “The flat-earth claim is meaningful and false, and the Absolute claim excludes every possible empirical test.” - **D:** False proposition: “Both claims are meaningful because each contains a familiar grammatical subject.” Correct doctrine: Grammatical familiarity does not establish verification conditions. Correct replacement: “The flat-earth claim is meaningful and false, and the Absolute claim excludes every possible empirical test.”

Examiner trap 6: Using 'false' and 'meaningless' interchangeably.

Repair action: Contrast a failed test with a sentence for which no test is specifiable.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2021 Q2(b).

MCQ 7

Which classification follows the positivist two-route account of cognitive meaning?

A. A tautology and a metaphysical assertion are equally meaningless because neither reports an observation or predicts an event. B. A moral command is analytic, and a scientific report has merely emotive significance. C. A tautology is analytically meaningful, while a contingent report is meaningful through possible experience. D. Every grammatically complete sentence possesses cognitive meaning regardless of its empirical role.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "A tautology and a metaphysical assertion are equally meaningless because neither reports an observation or predicts an event." Correct doctrine: Tautologies are retained as analytic although factually empty. Correct replacement: "A tautology is analytically meaningful, while a contingent report is meaningful through possible experience." - **B:** False proposition: "A moral command is analytic, and a scientific report has merely emotive significance." Correct doctrine: Commands are not thereby analytic, and scientific reports are factual claims. Correct replacement: "A tautology is analytically meaningful, while a contingent report is meaningful through possible experience." - **C:** The analytic and empirical routes differ, but both lie within cognitive significance. - **D:** False proposition: "Every grammatically complete sentence possesses cognitive meaning regardless of its empirical role." Correct doctrine: The theory denies that grammar alone guarantees cognitive sense. Correct replacement: "A tautology is analytically meaningful, while a contingent report is meaningful through possible experience."

Examiner trap 7: Forgetting that analytic propositions form a meaningful class.

Repair action: Memorise A-or-E: analytic or empirically testable.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2024 Q3(b).

MCQ 8

When positivists call ethics, ritual or poetry 'cognitively meaningless', the careful interpretation is that such language:

A. Such language is unintelligible noise that competent speakers cannot understand or use. B. Such language is empirically false because scientific observation directly contradicts it. C. Such language becomes meaningful only after translation into an analytic tautology. D. Such language states no verifiable fact and may retain expressive, practical or aesthetic significance.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Such language is unintelligible noise that competent speakers cannot understand or use." Correct doctrine: Ayer recognises emotive force while denying factual content. Correct replacement: "Such language states no verifiable fact and may retain expressive, practical or aesthetic significance." - **B:** False proposition: "Such language is empirically false because scientific

observation directly contradicts it." Correct doctrine: Non-cognitive utterances are not assigned ordinary empirical truth-values. Correct replacement: "Such language states no verifiable fact and may retain expressive, practical or aesthetic significance." - **C:** False proposition: "Such language becomes meaningful only after translation into an analytic tautology." Correct doctrine: Expressive and practical roles are not converted into analytic truths. Correct replacement: "Such language states no verifiable fact and may retain expressive, practical or aesthetic significance." - **D:** The criterion targets truth-aptness and does not erase every human use of language.

Examiner trap 8: Turning factual meaning into a verdict of total worthlessness.

Repair action: Always qualify 'meaningless' with 'cognitively' or 'factually'.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(e); 2023 Q3(a).

MCQ 9

A proposition is verifiable in the strong sense when:

A. Strong verification requires evidence that changes a proposition's probability without settling it. B. Strong verification requires coherence with a theory even when no observation bears on it. C. Strong verification requires one possible falsifier and requires no confirming observation. D. Strong verification requires a finite set of observations that conclusively establishes truth.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Strong verification requires evidence that changes a proposition's probability without settling it." Correct doctrine: That is the weak or probabilistic sense. Correct replacement: "Strong verification requires a finite set of observations that conclusively establishes truth." - **B:** False proposition: "Strong verification requires coherence with a theory even when no observation bears on it." Correct doctrine: Coherence alone does not satisfy Ayer's strong criterion. Correct replacement: "Strong verification requires a finite set of observations that conclusively establishes truth." - **C:** False proposition: "Strong verification requires one possible falsifier and requires no confirming observation." Correct doctrine: That resembles Popperian falsifiability, a demarcation criterion. Correct replacement: "Strong verification requires a finite set of observations that conclusively establishes truth." - **D:** Strong verification demands decisive establishment rather than relevant evidence alone.

Examiner trap 9: Replacing conclusive verification with confirmation or falsification.

Repair action: Write 'finite observations plus certainty' for the strong sense.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 10

Ayer's weak sense counts a proposition as verifiable when:

A. Weak verification requires possible experience that raises or lowers a proposition's probability. B. Weak verification requires the proposition's denial to contradict the rules of language. C. Weak verification requires direct observation of every instance covered by a proposition. D. Weak verification requires scientists to adopt the proposition as a useful framework rule.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Weak verification relaxes conclusive proof to evidential relevance or probability. - **B:** False proposition: "Weak verification requires the proposition's denial to contradict the rules of language." Correct doctrine: That makes it analytic rather than weakly empirical. Correct replacement: "Weak verification requires possible experience that raises or lowers a proposition's probability." - **C:** False proposition: "Weak verification requires direct observation of every instance covered by a proposition." Correct doctrine: Universal claims cannot meet this exhaustive demand. Correct replacement: "Weak verification requires possible experience that raises or lowers a proposition's probability." - **D:** False proposition: "Weak verification requires scientists to adopt the proposition as a useful framework rule." Correct doctrine: Framework adoption and empirical confirmation are distinct. Correct replacement: "Weak verification requires possible experience that raises or lowers a proposition's probability."

Examiner trap 10: Defining weak verification without probabilistic relevance.

Repair action: Use 'some possible observation bears on probability'.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q2(a); 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 11

Before spacecraft could inspect it, 'There are mountains on the far side of the Moon' remained meaningful because:

A. The lunar claim was analytic because mountains belong to the definition of the Moon. B. The lunar claim followed logically from the positivist programme for unifying science. C. The lunar claim needed no possible evidence because scientists already considered it probable. D. The lunar claim specified a possible observation even before that observation was practicable.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The lunar claim was analytic because mountains belong to the definition of the Moon." Correct doctrine: Mountain distribution is contingent, not analytic. Correct replacement: "The lunar claim specified a possible observation even before that observation was practicable." - **B:** False proposition: "The lunar claim followed logically from the positivist programme for unifying science." Correct doctrine: Linguistic coordination cannot establish a lunar fact. Correct replacement: "The lunar claim specified a possible observation even before that observation was practicable." - **C:** False proposition: "The lunar claim needed no possible evidence because scientists already considered it probable." Correct doctrine: Acceptance without a possible test would not satisfy verificationism. Correct replacement: "The lunar claim specified a possible observation even before that observation was practicable." - **D:** The distinction concerns conceptual accessibility of a test, not current ability to perform it.

Examiner trap 11: Confusing unavailable evidence with impossible evidence.

Repair action: State the hypothetical procedure even when technology is absent.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 12

What best distinguishes direct from indirect verification in Ayer's revised discussion?

A. Direct verification applies to analytic truths, and indirect verification applies to moral claims. B. Direct verification is conclusive, and indirect verification necessarily establishes falsity. C. Direct verification is private, and indirect verification is always a public convention. D. Direct verification links a claim to observation immediately, and indirect verification uses auxiliary premises.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Direct verification applies to analytic truths, and indirect verification applies to moral claims." Correct doctrine: Analytic truths are not observationally verified, and moral claims are not rescued this way. Correct replacement: "Direct verification links a claim to observation immediately, and indirect verification uses auxiliary premises." - **B:** False proposition: "Direct verification is conclusive, and indirect verification necessarily establishes falsity." Correct doctrine: Directness and strength are different axes; indirect claims can receive support. Correct replacement: "Direct verification links a claim to observation immediately, and indirect verification uses auxiliary premises." - **C:** False proposition: "Direct verification is private, and indirect verification is always a public convention." Correct doctrine: The distinction concerns inferential route, not simply privacy. Correct replacement: "Direct verification links a claim to observation immediately, and indirect verification uses auxiliary premises." - **D:** Indirect testing connects laws and theoretical statements with experience through auxiliaries and predictions.

Examiner trap 12: Collapsing direct/indirect into strong/weak.

Repair action: Keep two axes: decisiveness and inferential distance.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2019 Q2(a).

MCQ 13

Why do unrestricted scientific laws create trouble for strong verification?

A. Universal scientific laws are analytic conventions whose necessity comes entirely from stipulated linguistic definitions. B. No finite collection of observations can establish every observed and unobserved instance of a universal law. C. Universal scientific laws are metaphysical simply because they employ general terms. D. A single counter-instance verifies a universal law by decisively testing its scope.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Universal scientific laws are analytic conventions whose necessity comes entirely from stipulated linguistic definitions." Correct doctrine: Scientific laws are synthetic claims, though support may be indirect. Correct replacement: "No finite collection of observations can establish every observed and unobserved instance of a universal law." - **B:** Universality outruns any finite confirming sample. - **C:** False proposition: "Universal scientific laws are metaphysical simply because they employ general terms." Correct doctrine: Generality alone does not remove observational consequences. Correct replacement: "No finite collection of observations can establish every observed and unobserved instance of a universal law." - **D:** False proposition: "A single counter-instance verifies a universal law by decisively testing its scope." Correct doctrine: A counter-instance falsifies rather than verifies a universal. Correct replacement: "No finite collection of observations can establish every observed and unobserved instance of a universal law."

Examiner trap 13: Assuming repeated confirmation logically proves a universal.

Repair action: Mention finite evidence versus unrestricted quantification.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2019 Q2(a).

MCQ 14

Which chronology of Ayer's criterion and Church's criticism is correct?

A. Ayer revised the criterion in 1936, Church answered it in 1946, and the original Language, Truth and Logic appeared in 1949. B. Church proposed strong verification in 1936, and Ayer replaced it with falsifiability in 1949. C. Ayer published his criterion only after Church had already demonstrated its formal defect. D. Ayer's first edition appeared in 1936, his revised Introduction in 1946, and Church's objection in 1949.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Ayer revised the criterion in 1936, Church answered it in 1946, and the original Language, Truth and Logic appeared in 1949." Correct doctrine: This reverses publication and criticism dates. Correct replacement: "Ayer's first edition appeared in 1936, his revised Introduction in 1946, and Church's objection in 1949." - **B:** False proposition: "Church proposed strong verification in 1936, and Ayer replaced it with falsifiability in 1949." Correct doctrine: Church criticised Ayer; falsifiability belongs to Popper. Correct replacement: "Ayer's first edition appeared in 1936, his revised Introduction in 1946, and Church's objection in 1949." - **C:** False proposition: "Ayer published his criterion only after Church had already demonstrated its formal defect." Correct doctrine: Ayer's book and revision precede Church's review. Correct replacement: "Ayer's first edition appeared in 1936, his revised Introduction in 1946, and Church's objection in 1949." - **D:** The sequence records formulation, repair and formal permissiveness criticism.

Examiner trap 14: Dating the technical revision to the first edition.

Repair action: Lock the sequence 1936–1946–1949.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 15

What is the force of Church's 1949 objection to Ayer's revised test?

A. Church proved that observations cannot support even singular empirical statements. B. Church showed that analytic truths become synthetic whenever they enter arguments containing empirical auxiliary premises. C. Church showed that suitable conjunctions let arbitrary propositions satisfy Ayer's revised criterion. D. Church established falsifiability as a definition of meaning equivalent to verification.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Church proved that observations cannot support even singular empirical statements." Correct doctrine: The objection targets the criterion's breadth, not all reports. Correct replacement: "Church showed that suitable conjunctions let arbitrary propositions satisfy Ayer's revised criterion." - **B:** False proposition: "Church showed that analytic truths become synthetic whenever they enter arguments containing empirical auxiliary premises." Correct doctrine: The issue is not a change of analytic status. Correct replacement: "Church showed that suitable conjunctions let arbitrary propositions satisfy Ayer's revised criterion." - **C:** Church shows the proposed conditions are too permissive. - **D:** False proposition: "Church established falsifiability as a definition of meaning equivalent to verification." Correct doctrine: Church does not identify verification with Popperian demarcation. Correct replacement: "Church showed that suitable conjunctions let arbitrary propositions satisfy Ayer's revised criterion."

Examiner trap 15: Remembering Church as merely self-refutation.

Repair action: Describe admission of arbitrary statements.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 16

Schlick's difference-argument most directly supports the claim that:

A. The difference-argument requires every meaningful statement to have been conclusively verified. B. Hypotheses with no possible observational difference lack a difference in cognitive content. C. The difference-argument establishes that only physicalist vocabulary is intelligible. D. The difference-argument requires science to eliminate every theoretical entity.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The difference-argument requires every meaningful statement to have been conclusively verified." Correct doctrine: It invokes possible difference, not completed strong verification. Correct replacement: "Hypotheses with no possible observational difference

lack a difference in cognitive content.” - **B:** Its force is that factual content must make some possible difference to evidence. - **C:** False proposition: “The difference-argument establishes that only physicalist vocabulary is intelligible.” Correct doctrine: Physicalism is one unity strategy, not this argument. Correct replacement: “Hypotheses with no possible observational difference lack a difference in cognitive content.” - **D:** False proposition: “The difference-argument requires science to eliminate every theoretical entity.” Correct doctrine: Theoretical terms may retain content through systematic consequences. Correct replacement: “Hypotheses with no possible observational difference lack a difference in cognitive content.”

Examiner trap 16: Inflating a significance heuristic into strong verification.

Repair action: Say: no possible evidential difference, no cognitive difference.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 17

Einstein's influence on the Circle is most carefully stated as follows:

- A. Relativity proved that every meaningful sentence reduces to one speaker's private sensations.
- B. Relativity modelled procedural clarification of simultaneity without proving a universal theory of meaning.
- C. Special relativity established the analytic-synthetic distinction and made scientific conventions unrevisable.
- D. Einstein's physics supplied Ayer with the emotive analysis of ethical language.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: “Relativity proved that every meaningful sentence reduces to one speaker's private sensations.” Correct doctrine: Einstein did not establish phenomenalist reduction. Correct replacement: “Relativity modelled procedural clarification of simultaneity without proving a universal theory of meaning.” - **B:** Relativity offered a model of clarification, not a deduction of verificationism. - **C:** False proposition: “Special relativity established the analytic-synthetic distinction and made scientific conventions unrevisable.” Correct doctrine: Relativity does not settle Quine's later challenge. Correct replacement: “Relativity modelled procedural clarification of simultaneity without proving a universal theory of meaning.” - **D:** False proposition: “Einstein's physics supplied Ayer with the emotive analysis of ethical language.” Correct doctrine: Emotivism is unrelated to Einstein's physics. Correct replacement: “Relativity modelled procedural clarification of simultaneity without proving a universal theory of meaning.”

Examiner trap 17: Using a historical influence as a logical proof.

Repair action: Write 'model and motivation, not entailment'.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: Positive case; 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 18

Which presupposition is directly destabilised by the Schlick–Neurath protocol debate?

A. The protocol debate destabilises the synthetic a priori by treating all necessary truths as reports of immediate experience. B. The protocol debate concerns whether metaphysical entities occupy space and time. C. The protocol debate establishes that falsifiability and verifiability are identical. D. The protocol debate destabilises belief in a neutral, epistemically privileged observation language.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The protocol debate destabilises the synthetic a priori by treating all necessary truths as reports of immediate experience." Correct doctrine: The Circle rejects that category; protocols concern observation. Correct replacement: "The protocol debate destabilises belief in a neutral, epistemically privileged observation language." - **B:** False proposition: "The protocol debate concerns whether metaphysical entities occupy space and time." Correct doctrine: The debate concerns empirical foundations, not metaphysical location. Correct replacement: "The protocol debate destabilises belief in a neutral, epistemically privileged observation language." - **C:** False proposition: "The protocol debate establishes that falsifiability and verifiability are identical." Correct doctrine: Popper's criterion addresses a separate problem. Correct replacement: "The protocol debate destabilises belief in a neutral, epistemically privileged observation language." - **D:** Their dispute over certainty, publicity and revisability shows the evidential base was not agreed.

Examiner trap 18: Treating the protocol controversy as minor terminology.

Repair action: Connect it to the absence of an agreed observational base.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 19

Duhem–Quine holism challenges sentence-by-sentence verification because:

A. Holism holds that observation can never rationally influence any scientific belief. B. Holism holds that scientific laws are analytic commitments immune to revision. C. Holism holds that predictions confront experience with auxiliaries and a wider theory, not in isolation. D. Holism confines background assumptions to metaphysics and lets scientific predictions face observations alone.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Holism holds that observation can never rationally influence any scientific belief." Correct doctrine: Holism denies isolated testing, not empirical constraint. Correct replacement: "Holism holds that predictions confront experience with auxiliaries and a wider theory, not in isolation." - **B:** False proposition: "Holism holds that scientific laws are analytic commitments immune to revision." Correct doctrine: Quine makes even central commitments revisable in principle. Correct replacement: "Holism holds that predictions confront experience with auxiliaries and a wider theory, not in isolation." - **C:** Failed predictions underdetermine which component of the network should change. - **D:**

False proposition: "Holism confines background assumptions to metaphysics and lets scientific predictions face observations alone." Correct doctrine: Scientific tests also require auxiliaries and instruments. Correct replacement: "Holism holds that predictions confront experience with auxiliaries and a wider theory, not in isolation."

Examiner trap 19: Misreading holism as scepticism about evidence.

Repair action: Say experience constrains the web, not one sentence uniquely.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 20

What exactly changes when the Circle moves from the *Tractatus* to verificationism?

A. The Circle simply renamed Wittgensteinian objects as Neurathian protocol sentences. B. The Circle added an epistemic demand for verification conditions to a logical account of truth-conditions. C. The *Tractatus* already contained Ayer's 1946 direct-indirect criterion in its final form. D. The Circle abandoned logical form and replaced it with Hegelian dialectical development.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The Circle simply renamed Wittgensteinian objects as Neurathian protocol sentences." Correct doctrine: Tractarian objects and positivist protocols are not the same base. Correct replacement: "The Circle added an epistemic demand for verification conditions to a logical account of truth-conditions." - **B:** The added epistemic step generates the strong/weak problem. - **C:** False proposition: "The *Tractatus* already contained Ayer's 1946 direct-indirect criterion in its final form." Correct doctrine: Ayer's technical criterion is later. Correct replacement: "The Circle added an epistemic demand for verification conditions to a logical account of truth-conditions." - **D:** False proposition: "The Circle abandoned logical form and replaced it with Hegelian dialectical development." Correct doctrine: The Circle uses modern logic, not dialectical metaphysics. Correct replacement: "The Circle added an epistemic demand for verification conditions to a logical account of truth-conditions."

Examiner trap 20: Saying the *Tractatus* simply states verificationism.

Repair action: Contrast truth-conditions with verification-conditions.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: Lineage; 2026 Q4(a) boundary.

MCQ 21

Which sequence accurately represents the *Tractatus*-to-positivism historical line?

A. The Tractatus appeared in 1921/22, the Circle read it in 1926-27, conversations followed in 1929-32, and Ayer published in 1936. B. The manifesto appeared in 1918, the Tractatus in 1929, Ayer published in 1932, and the conversations began in 1946. C. Ayer published in 1921, the Circle read him in 1936, the manifesto appeared in 1949, and Church joined the conversations in 1951. D. Wittgenstein joined the Circle in 1926, Popper led it in 1929, and Quine wrote its manifesto.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** This orders text, reception, conversations and transmission. - **B:** False proposition: "The manifesto appeared in 1918, the Tractatus in 1929, Ayer published in 1932, and the conversations began in 1946." Correct doctrine: The Tractatus appeared in 1921/22, the manifesto in 1929, Ayer's exposition in 1936, and the recorded conversations occurred in 1929-32. Correct replacement: "The Tractatus appeared in 1921/22, the Circle read it in 1926-27, conversations followed in 1929-32, and Ayer published in 1936." - **C:** False proposition: "Ayer published in 1921, the Circle read him in 1936, the manifesto appeared in 1949, and Church joined the conversations in 1951." Correct doctrine: Ayer published Language, Truth and Logic in 1936; the Circle read the Tractatus in 1926-27, issued its manifesto in 1929, and Church criticised Ayer's revised criterion in 1949. Correct replacement: "The Tractatus appeared in 1921/22, the Circle read it in 1926-27, conversations followed in 1929-32, and Ayer published in 1936." - **D:** False proposition: "Wittgenstein joined the Circle in 1926, Popper led it in 1929, and Quine wrote its manifesto." Correct doctrine: Wittgenstein never joined the Circle, Popper did not lead it, and Hahn, Neurath and Carnap—not Quine—authored the 1929 manifesto. Correct replacement: "The Tractatus appeared in 1921/22, the Circle read it in 1926-27, conversations followed in 1929-32, and Ayer published in 1936."

Examiner trap 21: Knowing influence but scrambling provenance.

Repair action: Recall 21/22-26/27-29/32-36.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: Provenance across all answers.

MCQ 22

Which statement best preserves Wittgenstein's institutional boundary?

A. Wittgenstein founded the Vienna Circle and appointed Schlick as its official spokesman. B. Wittgenstein co-authored the manifesto and adopted Neurath's physicalist protocol language. C. Wittgenstein influenced Schlick and Waismann and remained outside the Circle. D. Wittgenstein developed the strong-weak terminology that Ayer later popularised.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Wittgenstein founded the Vienna Circle and appointed Schlick as its official spokesman." Correct doctrine: Schlick led the Circle; Wittgenstein did not found it. Correct replacement: "Wittgenstein influenced Schlick and Waismann and remained outside the Circle." - **B:** False proposition: "Wittgenstein co-authored the manifesto and adopted Neurath's physicalist protocol language." Correct doctrine: The manifesto authors were Hahn, Neurath and Carnap. Correct replacement: "Wittgenstein influenced Schlick and Waismann and remained outside the Circle." - **C:** Influence and

conversation do not establish membership. - **D:** False proposition: "Wittgenstein developed the strong-weak terminology that Ayer later popularised." Correct doctrine: The terminology is especially associated with Ayer. Correct replacement: "Wittgenstein influenced Schlick and Waismann and remained outside the Circle."

Examiner trap 22: Converting influence into institutional membership.

Repair action: Use 'influence without membership'.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: Owner boundary.

MCQ 23

How should the contrast over ethics between the *Tractatus* and Ayer be expressed?

A. Both early Wittgenstein and Ayer reduce ethical utterances to reports of private psychology. B. Early Wittgenstein places value outside factual saying, and Ayer treats moral utterances as non-cognitive expressions. C. Both early Wittgenstein and Ayer treat ethical claims as weakly confirmed scientific hypotheses about observable conduct. D. Ayer preserves ineffable ethical truths in exactly the form proposed by the *Tractatus*.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Both early Wittgenstein and Ayer reduce ethical utterances to reports of private psychology." Correct doctrine: Ayer distinguishes expression from report; the *Tractatus* offers no such reduction. Correct replacement: "Early Wittgenstein places value outside factual saying, and Ayer treats moral utterances as non-cognitive expressions." - **B:** Both deny ordinary factual description, but their positive treatments differ. - **C:** False proposition: "Both early Wittgenstein and Ayer treat ethical claims as weakly confirmed scientific hypotheses about observable conduct." Correct doctrine: Neither makes value a straightforward hypothesis. Correct replacement: "Early Wittgenstein places value outside factual saying, and Ayer treats moral utterances as non-cognitive expressions." - **D:** False proposition: "Ayer preserves ineffable ethical truths in exactly the form proposed by the *Tractatus*." Correct doctrine: Ayer's emotivism is an added metaethical account. Correct replacement: "Early Wittgenstein places value outside factual saying, and Ayer treats moral utterances as non-cognitive expressions."

Examiner trap 23: Equating every non-factual treatment of value.

Repair action: Name showing/unsayable versus emotive expression.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(e); lineage.

MCQ 24

Carnap recognises two principal ways in which a pseudostatement may arise:

A. A pseudostatement arises whenever a proposition is false, lacks conclusive evidence, or awaits improved scientific instruments. B. A pseudostatement arises whenever a sentence expresses emotion or employs a metaphor. C. A pseudostatement arises whenever a claim is universal or contains a theoretical term. D. A pseudostatement arises whenever a term lacks application criteria or a combination yields no truth-conditions.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "A pseudostatement arises whenever a proposition is false, lacks conclusive evidence, or awaits improved scientific instruments." Correct doctrine: False and underconfirmed propositions can remain meaningful. Correct replacement: "A pseudostatement arises whenever a term lacks application criteria or a combination yields no truth-conditions." - **B:** False proposition: "A pseudostatement arises whenever a sentence expresses emotion or employs a metaphor." Correct doctrine: Expressive force and metaphor are not the two diagnostics. Correct replacement: "A pseudostatement arises whenever a term lacks application criteria or a combination yields no truth-conditions." - **C:** False proposition: "A pseudostatement arises whenever a claim is universal or contains a theoretical term." Correct doctrine: Both may be indirectly testable. Correct replacement: "A pseudostatement arises whenever a term lacks application criteria or a combination yields no truth-conditions." - **D:** The first is vocabulary failure; the second is logical-syntactic or category failure.

Examiner trap 24: Calling every difficult or theoretical sentence pseudo.

Repair action: Apply term criterion, then logical combination.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q2(b).

MCQ 25

Carnap's diagnosis of Heidegger's 'Nothing noths' focuses on:

A. Carnap diagnoses 'nothing' as a naming subject joined to a pseudo-verb, with surface grammar masking logical failure. B. Carnap treats 'Nothing noths' as an empirical claim about anxiety that later observation refuted. C. Carnap derives the defect in 'Nothing noths' solely from the law of excluded middle. D. Carnap treats 'Nothing noths' as a legitimate analytic definition of non-being.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** The criticism is logico-syntactic, not mere ridicule. - **B:** False proposition: "Carnap treats 'Nothing noths' as an empirical claim about anxiety that later observation refuted." Correct doctrine: Carnap does not treat it as an ordinary psychological hypothesis. Correct replacement: "Carnap diagnoses 'nothing' as a naming subject joined to a pseudo-verb, with surface grammar masking logical failure." - **C:** False proposition: "Carnap derives the defect in 'Nothing noths' solely from the law of excluded middle." Correct doctrine: The diagnosis concerns misuse of logical grammar. Correct replacement: "Carnap diagnoses 'nothing' as a naming subject joined to a pseudo-verb, with surface grammar masking logical failure." - **D:** False proposition: "Carnap treats 'Nothing noths' as a legitimate

analytic definition of non-being." Correct doctrine: For Carnap it fails to state an analytic proposition. Correct replacement: "Carnap diagnoses 'nothing' as a naming subject joined to a pseudo-verb, with surface grammar masking logical failure."

Examiner trap 25: Ridiculing the phrase without explaining the error.

Repair action: Use the exact rendering and identify both violations.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q2(b); 2023 Q3(a).

MCQ 26

Why is 'Caesar is a prime number' a useful diagnostic example?

A. The Caesar sentence is a false historical report that Roman records can disprove. B. The Caesar sentence is an analytic contradiction equivalent to 'Caesar is not Caesar'. C. The Caesar sentence is a scientific generalisation awaiting archaeological confirmation about Roman mathematical practices. D. The Caesar sentence is a category error combining familiar words without coherent verification conditions.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The Caesar sentence is a false historical report that Roman records can disprove." Correct doctrine: The defect is category mismatch, not ordinary historical falsity. Correct replacement: "The Caesar sentence is a category error combining familiar words without coherent verification conditions." - **B:** False proposition: "The Caesar sentence is an analytic contradiction equivalent to 'Caesar is not Caesar'." Correct doctrine: It is not a formal contradiction of identity. Correct replacement: "The Caesar sentence is a category error combining familiar words without coherent verification conditions." - **C:** False proposition: "The Caesar sentence is a scientific generalisation awaiting archaeological confirmation about Roman mathematical practices." Correct doctrine: No evidence turns a person into a prime number. Correct replacement: "The Caesar sentence is a category error combining familiar words without coherent verification conditions." - **D:** It shows how meaningful expressions can be combined defectively.

Examiner trap 26: Treating category failure as empirical falsity.

Repair action: Ask whether the predicate applies to that subject-kind.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q2(b).

MCQ 27

In the 2023 meaning–knowledge–reality question, the best ranked verdict is that rejection of metaphysics is:

A. The rejection is primarily semantic, grounded in empiricist assumptions and consequential for ontological discourse. B. The rejection reports the empirical discovery that all metaphysical entities fail to exist. C. The rejection merely repeats Kant's epistemic limit on things in themselves and leaves the cognitive meaning of metaphysics intact. D. The rejection presents meaning, knowledge and ontology as unrelated problems of equal priority.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** This states the semantic innovation while acknowledging its ground and effect. - **B:** False proposition: "The rejection reports the empirical discovery that all metaphysical entities fail to exist." Correct doctrine: That preserves the sentences as meaningful but false. Correct replacement: "The rejection is primarily semantic, grounded in empiricist assumptions and consequential for ontological discourse." - **C:** False proposition: "The rejection merely repeats Kant's epistemic limit on things in themselves and leaves the cognitive meaning of metaphysics intact." Correct doctrine: Positivists make the stronger claim of absent cognitive sense. Correct replacement: "The rejection is primarily semantic, grounded in empiricist assumptions and consequential for ontological discourse." - **D:** False proposition: "The rejection presents meaning, knowledge and ontology as unrelated problems of equal priority." Correct doctrine: The answer must rank meaning as primary. Correct replacement: "The rejection is primarily semantic, grounded in empiricist assumptions and consequential for ontological discourse."

Examiner trap 27: Answering 'all three' without asymmetry.

Repair action: Write meaning as root, epistemology as ground, ontology as consequence.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q3(a).

MCQ 28

Which treatment of a transcendent theological claim is most faithful to Ayer's criterion?

A. Science conclusively falsifies a transcendent claim by observing every possible region of reality. B. A believer's definition makes a transcendent existence-claim analytic, necessary, and cognitively meaningful without observation. C. A transcendent factual claim lacks possible empirical conditions, and its ritual or expressive uses require separate analysis. D. A transcendent claim becomes weakly verified whenever belief in it provides psychological comfort.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Science conclusively falsifies a transcendent claim by observing every possible region of reality." Correct doctrine: Verificationism does not claim exhaustive observation. Correct replacement: "A transcendent factual claim lacks possible empirical conditions, and its ritual or expressive uses require separate analysis." - **B:** False proposition: "A believer's definition makes a transcendent existence-claim analytic, necessary, and cognitively meaningful without observation." Correct doctrine: Stipulation does not make existence tautological. Correct replacement: "A transcendent factual claim lacks possible empirical conditions, and its ritual or expressive uses require separate analysis." - **C:** The criterion denies cognitive truth-aptness while leaving non-factual functions open. - **D:** False proposition: "A transcendent claim becomes weakly verified whenever belief in it provides psychological

comfort." Correct doctrine: Psychological effects do not verify the asserted object. Correct replacement: "A transcendent factual claim lacks possible empirical conditions, and its ritual or expressive uses require separate analysis."

Examiner trap 28: Using practical effects as evidence for the literal claim.

Repair action: Separate factual assertion from ritual and expression.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2020 Q1(e).

MCQ 29

Which set contains an analytic claim, an empirical claim and a positivist pseudostatement, in that order?

A. The sequence is empirical, analytic and empirical, namely 'The road is wet', 'All bachelors are unmarried' and 'Electrons carry negative charge'. B. The sequence is metaphysical, analytic and empirical, namely 'God is transcendent', 'Two plus two equals four' and 'The page is white'. C. The sequence is analytic, empirical and metaphysical, namely 'Either it rains or not', 'The road is wet' and 'The Absolute is beyond testing'. D. The sequence is evaluative, metaphysical and empirical, namely 'Pain is unpleasant', 'Reality is spiritual' and 'Some metals conduct electricity'.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The sequence is empirical, analytic and empirical, namely 'The road is wet', 'All bachelors are unmarried' and 'Electrons carry negative charge'." Correct doctrine: The first two are reversed and the last is indirectly empirical. Correct replacement: "The sequence is analytic, empirical and metaphysical, namely 'Either it rains or not', 'The road is wet' and 'The Absolute is beyond testing'." - **B:** False proposition: "The sequence is metaphysical, analytic and empirical, namely 'God is transcendent', 'Two plus two equals four' and 'The page is white'." Correct doctrine: This begins with the pseudostatement and ends empirical. Correct replacement: "The sequence is analytic, empirical and metaphysical, namely 'Either it rains or not', 'The road is wet' and 'The Absolute is beyond testing'." - **C:** The sequence instantiates tautology, observation and insulated metaphysics. - **D:** False proposition: "The sequence is evaluative, metaphysical and empirical, namely 'Pain is unpleasant', 'Reality is spiritual' and 'Some metals conduct electricity'." Correct doctrine: The middle is metaphysical and the last testable. Correct replacement: "The sequence is analytic, empirical and metaphysical, namely 'Either it rains or not', 'The road is wet' and 'The Absolute is beyond testing'."

Examiner trap 29: Classifying by familiarity rather than the two routes.

Repair action: Test form first, then possible observations.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q2(b); 2024 Q3(b).

MCQ 30

On Ayer's emotivism, saying 'Stealing is wrong' differs from saying 'I disapprove of stealing' because the former:

A. The moral utterance describes a non-natural property known through ethical intuition. B. The moral utterance expresses disapproval without reporting the speaker's psychological state. C. The moral utterance states an analytic definition of the action called stealing. D. The moral utterance predicts that every competent listener shares the speaker's feeling and will display the same conduct.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The moral utterance describes a non-natural property known through ethical intuition." Correct doctrine: That is cognitivist intuitionism. Correct replacement: "The moral utterance expresses disapproval without reporting the speaker's psychological state." - **B:** A report is truth-apt; an expression adds no factual content on Ayer's view. - **C:** False proposition: "The moral utterance states an analytic definition of the action called stealing." Correct doctrine: The moral predicate is not true by definition. Correct replacement: "The moral utterance expresses disapproval without reporting the speaker's psychological state." - **D:** False proposition: "The moral utterance predicts that every competent listener shares the speaker's feeling and will display the same conduct." Correct doctrine: Influence does not make a universal prediction. Correct replacement: "The moral utterance expresses disapproval without reporting the speaker's psychological state."

Examiner trap 30: Calling emotivism subjectivism.

Repair action: Contrast EXPRESS with REPORT.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(e).

MCQ 31

Stevenson's account goes beyond Ayer chiefly by emphasising:

A. Stevenson proves that moral predicates denote objective properties whose descriptive content settles disagreements in attitude. B. Stevenson denies the possibility of moral debate once disagreement about facts has ended. C. Stevenson reduces ethical meaning to strong verification through observable behaviour. D. Stevenson combines descriptive and emotive meaning with disagreement in attitude and persuasion.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Stevenson proves that moral predicates denote objective properties whose descriptive content settles disagreements in attitude." Correct doctrine: Stevenson remains non-cognitivist. Correct replacement: "Stevenson combines descriptive and emotive meaning with disagreement in attitude and persuasion." - **B:** False proposition: "Stevenson denies the possibility of moral debate once disagreement about facts has ended." Correct doctrine: Stevenson allows disagreement in attitude. Correct replacement: "Stevenson combines descriptive and emotive meaning with disagreement

in attitude and persuasion.” - **C:** False proposition: “Stevenson reduces ethical meaning to strong verification through observable behaviour.” Correct doctrine: His theory is not strong verificationism. Correct replacement: “Stevenson combines descriptive and emotive meaning with disagreement in attitude and persuasion.” - **D:** He explains ethical disagreement without ordinary moral facts.

Examiner trap 31: Flattening Ayer and Stevenson into one doctrine.

Repair action: Mention dual meaning and disagreement in attitude.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(e); emotivism comparison.

MCQ 32

Which contrast about moral argument is accurate?

A. Ayer limits rational dispute mainly to facts, and Stevenson lets reasons and persuasive definitions redirect attitudes. B. Ayer treats moral conclusions as scientific laws, and Stevenson excludes persuasive definition from genuine ethical discussion. C. Ayer and Stevenson both classify value judgements as truths fixed by linguistic definition. D. Stevenson reduces every ethical disagreement to autobiographical reports about private feelings.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Stevenson gives non-cognitivism a richer account of disagreement. - **B:** False proposition: “Ayer treats moral conclusions as scientific laws, and Stevenson excludes persuasive definition from genuine ethical discussion.” Correct doctrine: Ayer restricts rational moral dispute largely to relevant facts, whereas Stevenson explicitly analyses persuasive language and disagreement in attitude. Correct replacement: “Ayer limits rational dispute mainly to facts, and Stevenson lets reasons and persuasive definitions redirect attitudes.” - **C:** False proposition: “Ayer and Stevenson both classify value judgements as truths fixed by linguistic definition.” Correct doctrine: They are non-cognitivists, not analytic moralists. Correct replacement: “Ayer limits rational dispute mainly to facts, and Stevenson lets reasons and persuasive definitions redirect attitudes.” - **D:** False proposition: “Stevenson reduces every ethical disagreement to autobiographical reports about private feelings.” Correct doctrine: He distinguishes belief from attitude. Correct replacement: “Ayer limits rational dispute mainly to facts, and Stevenson lets reasons and persuasive definitions redirect attitudes.”

Examiner trap 32: Assuming non-cognitivism bars all reasoning.

Repair action: State facts-only for Ayer, attitude-directed reasons for Stevenson.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(e).

MCQ 33

The Frege–Geach problem pressures simple emotivism because:

A. The Frege-Geach problem arises because a moral sentence keeps inferential content inside an unasserted conditional. B. The Frege-Geach problem claims that ethical sentences cannot be translated into ordinary language without losing their emotive force. C. The Frege-Geach problem establishes that moral predicates always name natural properties. D. The Frege-Geach problem denies that disagreement in attitude can survive factual agreement.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Expression theories must explain stable content in embedded valid arguments. - **B:** False proposition: "The Frege-Geach problem claims that ethical sentences cannot be translated into ordinary language without losing their emotive force." Correct doctrine: The issue is logical embedding. Correct replacement: "The Frege-Geach problem arises because a moral sentence keeps inferential content inside an unasserted conditional." - **C:** False proposition: "The Frege-Geach problem establishes that moral predicates always name natural properties." Correct doctrine: Embedding does not establish naturalism. Correct replacement: "The Frege-Geach problem arises because a moral sentence keeps inferential content inside an unasserted conditional." - **D:** False proposition: "The Frege-Geach problem denies that disagreement in attitude can survive factual agreement." Correct doctrine: Stevenson says it can remain. Correct replacement: "The Frege-Geach problem arises because a moral sentence keeps inferential content inside an unasserted conditional."

Examiner trap 33: Reducing Frege–Geach to mere emotionality.

Repair action: Use a conditional antecedent and track content.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: Emotivism criticism.

MCQ 34

A careful analysis of 'The Soul of Superman is Good' should separate:

A. The sentence requires a distinction between scientific falsification and analytic contradiction. B. The sentence combines a subject-reference problem with a non-descriptive evaluative predicate. C. The sentence combines a weakly verified subject with a strongly verified moral property. D. The sentence requires valid existential quantification followed by a colour observation.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The sentence requires a distinction between scientific falsification and analytic contradiction." Correct doctrine: Neither part is handled by that pair. Correct replacement: "The sentence combines a subject-reference problem with a non-descriptive evaluative predicate." - **B:** The sentence presents both a reference/verification problem and an emotivist value problem. - **C:** False proposition: "The sentence combines a weakly verified subject with a strongly verified moral property." Correct doctrine: The subject lacks application and the predicate is non-cognitive. Correct replacement: "The sentence combines a subject-reference problem with a non-descriptive evaluative predicate." - **D:** False proposition: "The sentence requires valid existential quantification followed by a colour observation." Correct doctrine: The sentence contains neither. Correct replacement: "The sentence combines a subject-reference problem with a non-descriptive evaluative predicate."

Examiner trap 34: Writing only 'meaningless' and missing two defects.

Repair action: Diagnose subject first, then 'Good' as emotive.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(e).

MCQ 35

The linguistic theory of necessary propositions explains necessity by claiming that logic and mathematics are:

A. Logic and mathematics are analytic consequences of linguistic rules and therefore add no empirical facts. B. Logic and mathematics are synthetic a priori truths imposed by the mind upon experience. C. Logic and mathematics are inductive generalisations that future observations may overturn. D. Logic and mathematics are intuitive insights into independently existing abstract objects grasped without linguistic conventions.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Necessity is placed in convention rather than supersensible facts or induction. - **B:** False proposition: "Logic and mathematics are synthetic a priori truths imposed by the mind upon experience." Correct doctrine: That is Kant's account, rejected here. Correct replacement: "Logic and mathematics are analytic consequences of linguistic rules and therefore add no empirical facts." - **C:** False proposition: "Logic and mathematics are inductive generalisations that future observations may overturn." Correct doctrine: That resembles Mill and misses necessity. Correct replacement: "Logic and mathematics are analytic consequences of linguistic rules and therefore add no empirical facts." - **D:** False proposition: "Logic and mathematics are intuitive insights into independently existing abstract objects grasped without linguistic conventions." Correct doctrine: The doctrine avoids rationalist ontology. Correct replacement: "Logic and mathematics are analytic consequences of linguistic rules and therefore add no empirical facts."

Examiner trap 35: Giving 'analytic' without the empiricist problem.

Repair action: Begin necessary, a priori, certain; then explain convention.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2024 Q3(b).

MCQ 36

Which comparison among Kant, Mill and the positivists is correct?

A. Kant and Mill make mathematics analytic, while positivists classify it as synthetic a priori. B. Kant defends synthetic a priori necessity, Mill gives an empirical account, and positivists make necessity linguistic. C. Mill grounds necessity in rational intuition, and Kant derives it from repeated observation. D. Kant, Mill and the positivists all explain mathematical necessity by reference to an independently existing supersensible realm.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Kant and Mill make mathematics analytic, while positivists classify it as synthetic a priori." Correct doctrine: This reverses the stated positions of Kant, Mill and the positivists. Correct replacement: "Kant defends synthetic a priori necessity, Mill gives an empirical account, and positivists make necessity linguistic." - **B:** The accounts place necessity in conditions of experience, induction and convention. - **C:** False proposition: "Mill grounds necessity in rational intuition, and Kant derives it from repeated observation." Correct doctrine: Mill is empiricist and Kant is not inductivist here. Correct replacement: "Kant defends synthetic a priori necessity, Mill gives an empirical account, and positivists make necessity linguistic." - **D:** False proposition: "Kant, Mill and the positivists all explain mathematical necessity by reference to an independently existing supersensible realm." Correct doctrine: Kant explains mathematical necessity through the synthetic a priori, Mill through empiricist generalisation, and positivists through analytic linguistic rules. Correct replacement: "Kant defends synthetic a priori necessity, Mill gives an empirical account, and positivists make necessity linguistic."

Examiner trap 36: Memorising labels without rival mechanisms.

Repair action: Use Kant–structure, Mill–induction, positivism–language.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: Linguistic necessity.

MCQ 37

For logical positivists, 'All objects are either red or not red' and 'This page is white' are:

A. Both sentences are empirical because each contains a predicate referring to colour. B. Both sentences are analytic because neither sentence can possibly be false. C. Both are meaningful, with the first analytic and tautological and the second empirical and contingent. D. The first sentence is meaningless, and one colour observation conclusively verifies the second with certainty.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Both sentences are empirical because each contains a predicate referring to colour." Correct doctrine: Vocabulary does not determine mode; logical form does. Correct replacement: "Both are meaningful, with the first analytic and tautological and the second empirical and contingent." - **B:** False proposition: "Both sentences are analytic because neither sentence can possibly be false." Correct doctrine: The page could be another colour. Correct replacement: "Both are meaningful, with the first analytic and tautological and the second empirical and contingent." - **C:** They enter different branches: logical necessity and contingent empirical content. - **D:** False proposition: "The first sentence is meaningless, and one colour observation conclusively verifies the second with certainty." Correct doctrine: Tautologies are meaningful and observation need not be infallible. Correct replacement: "Both are meaningful, with the first analytic and tautological and the second empirical and contingent."

Examiner trap 37: Classifying by subject matter rather than form.

Repair action: Translate the first as P or not-P.

Coverage mapping: C08.

MCQ 38

How do positivists most plausibly preserve the meaning of a general scientific law?

A. A general law remains meaningful through weak or indirect tests of its observational consequences. B. A general law remains meaningful only after being redefined as an analytic convention. C. A general law remains meaningful only after every possible instance has been observed. D. A general law remains meaningful as emotive guidance rather than as a truth-apt assertion.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** The law plus conditions yields predictions that can raise or lower support. - **B:** False proposition: "A general law remains meaningful only after being redefined as an analytic convention." Correct doctrine: That removes its empirical content. Correct replacement: "A general law remains meaningful through weak or indirect tests of its observational consequences." - **C:** False proposition: "A general law remains meaningful only after every possible instance has been observed." Correct doctrine: An unrestricted universal cannot be exhausted. Correct replacement: "A general law remains meaningful through weak or indirect tests of its observational consequences." - **D:** False proposition: "A general law remains meaningful as emotive guidance rather than as a truth-apt assertion." Correct doctrine: Scientific laws remain factual claims. Correct replacement: "A general law remains meaningful through weak or indirect tests of its observational consequences."

Examiner trap 38: Saying 'verified by examples' without indirect confirmation.

Repair action: Write law plus conditions -> prediction -> observation.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q2(a); 2018 Q3(b).

MCQ 39

Why need theoretical entities not be meaningless under a developed positivist account?

A. Theoretical entities are analytic definitions whose truth is immune to scientific revision. B. Theoretical entities are equivalent to transcendent beings because neither is directly visible. C. Theoretical entities gain empirical significance through laws and observable consequences of a theory-system. D. Theoretical entities possess meaning only when they are directly visible to unaided perception.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Theoretical entities are analytic definitions whose truth is immune to scientific revision." Correct doctrine: Theoretical science is not merely tautological. Correct replacement: "Theoretical entities gain empirical significance through laws and observable consequences of a theory-system." - **B:** False proposition: "Theoretical entities are equivalent to transcendent beings because neither is directly visible." Correct doctrine: Indirect consequences distinguish them. Correct replacement: "Theoretical entities gain empirical significance through laws and observable consequences

of a theory-system." - **C:** System-level testing permits indirect empirical content. - **D:** False proposition: "Theoretical entities possess meaning only when they are directly visible to unaided perception." Correct doctrine: Direct visibility is not required. Correct replacement: "Theoretical entities gain empirical significance through laws and observable consequences of a theory-system."

Examiner trap 39: Equating unobservable with unverifiable.

Repair action: Trace term to prediction, instrument and observation.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2019 Q2(a).

MCQ 40

Which contrast between phenomenalist reconstruction and physicalist language is accurate?

A. Phenomenalism reconstructs object-talk from experience, and physicalism seeks a public intersubjective language. B. Phenomenalism and physicalism are interchangeable names for private, incorrigible sense-data. C. Phenomenalism is Popperian falsificationism, and physicalism is Quinean holism applied to a common scientific vocabulary. D. Physicalism requires protocol sentences to be fixed permanently and protected from revision.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** These are distinct strategies within a diverse movement. - **B:** False proposition: "Phenomenalism and physicalism are interchangeable names for private, incorrigible sense-data." Correct doctrine: Physicalism partly responds to private-foundation problems. Correct replacement: "Phenomenalism reconstructs object-talk from experience, and physicalism seeks a public intersubjective language." - **C:** False proposition: "Phenomenalism is Popperian falsificationism, and physicalism is Quinean holism applied to a common scientific vocabulary." Correct doctrine: Those are later external projects. Correct replacement: "Phenomenalism reconstructs object-talk from experience, and physicalism seeks a public intersubjective language." - **D:** False proposition: "Physicalism requires protocol sentences to be fixed permanently and protected from revision." Correct doctrine: Neurath treats protocols as revisable. Correct replacement: "Phenomenalism reconstructs object-talk from experience, and physicalism seeks a public intersubjective language."

Examiner trap 40: Presenting one permanent reduction language.

Repair action: Contrast private experience with public physical coordination.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 41

The unity-of-science project is best described as an attempt to:

A. The unity project replaces the sciences with one comprehensive metaphysical account of reality. B. The unity project deduces every scientific law from a single privileged protocol sentence. C. The unity project coordinates scientific claims in a public language and permits disagreement about reduction. D. The unity project eliminates logical syntax so that each science can retain private meanings.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The unity project replaces the sciences with one comprehensive metaphysical account of reality." Correct doctrine: The programme opposed speculative metaphysics. Correct replacement: "The unity project coordinates scientific claims in a public language and permits disagreement about reduction." - **B:** False proposition: "The unity project deduces every scientific law from a single privileged protocol sentence." Correct doctrine: No single report entails the scientific system. Correct replacement: "The unity project coordinates scientific claims in a public language and permits disagreement about reduction." - **C:** Unity ranged from reconstruction to encyclopedic coordination. - **D:** False proposition: "The unity project eliminates logical syntax so that each science can retain private meanings." Correct doctrine: Logical syntax and intersubjectivity were central. Correct replacement: "The unity project coordinates scientific claims in a public language and permits disagreement about reduction."

Examiner trap 41: Equating unity with total private reduction.

Repair action: Use translation, coordination, public testability and diversity.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 42

Schlick's 'affirmations' in the protocol debate were intended as:

A. Schlick's affirmations are fallible physical reports revised solely to preserve systemic coherence. B. Schlick's affirmations are immediate here-now acts where understanding and verification coincide. C. Schlick's affirmations are analytic framework rules selected for their practical convenience. D. Schlick's affirmations are universal laws verified through an infinite series of observations.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Schlick's affirmations are fallible physical reports revised solely to preserve systemic coherence." Correct doctrine: Fallible physical reports describe Neurath's position, not Schlick's affirmations. Correct replacement: "Schlick's affirmations are immediate here-now acts where understanding and verification coincide." - **B:** Their advantage is certainty, but they cannot serve as stable public records. - **C:** False proposition: "Schlick's affirmations are analytic framework rules selected for their practical convenience." Correct doctrine: That belongs to Carnap's tolerance. Correct replacement: "Schlick's affirmations are immediate here-now acts where understanding and verification coincide." - **D:** False proposition: "Schlick's affirmations are universal laws verified through an infinite series of observations." Correct doctrine: Affirmations are singular acts. Correct replacement: "Schlick's affirmations are immediate here-now acts where understanding and verification coincide."

Examiner trap 42: Calling every protocol Schlickian and incorrigible.

Repair action: Remember certainty at the cost of recordability.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Protocol debate; 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 43

Neurath's protocol sentences and boat image jointly express the view that:

A. Neurath grounds protocol sentences in private, incorrigible experiences that supply a foundation outside every linguistic system. B. Neurath treats observation reports as public and fallible, revised aboard a system with no external foundation. C. Neurath's boat requires one final metalanguage capable of validating every scientific language. D. Neurath holds that coherence alone guarantees truth without empirical or practical constraint.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Neurath grounds protocol sentences in private, incorrigible experiences that supply a foundation outside every linguistic system." Correct doctrine: Neurath rejects that extra-linguistic foundation. Correct replacement: "Neurath treats observation reports as public and fallible, revised aboard a system with no external foundation." - **B:** Knowledge is repaired while afloat; no statement is absolutely immune. - **C:** False proposition: "Neurath's boat requires one final metalanguage capable of validating every scientific language." Correct doctrine: The boat concerns anti-foundational revision. Correct replacement: "Neurath treats observation reports as public and fallible, revised aboard a system with no external foundation." - **D:** False proposition: "Neurath holds that coherence alone guarantees truth without empirical or practical constraint." Correct doctrine: Actual practice constrains choice; the fairy-tale objection remains. Correct replacement: "Neurath treats observation reports as public and fallible, revised aboard a system with no external foundation."

Examiner trap 43: Remembering the metaphor without its point.

Repair action: Write statements compared with statements; repair from within.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Protocol debate; 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 44

Carnap's 1932 intervention in the protocol dispute proposes that protocol form is:

A. Carnap fixes protocol form through private sensation and excludes every later reformulation. B. Carnap lets Popper's falsifiability criterion determine the uniquely correct protocol form. C. Carnap treats protocol form as a choice of linguistic system rather than a uniquely given foundation. D. Carnap holds that reality fixes one uniquely correct protocol form independently of linguistic choices or pragmatic purposes.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Carnap fixes protocol form through private sensation and excludes every later reformulation." Correct doctrine: That favours the foundationalism he moves beyond. Correct replacement: "Carnap treats protocol form as a choice of linguistic system rather than a uniquely given foundation." - **B:** False proposition: "Carnap lets Popper's falsifiability criterion determine the uniquely correct protocol form." Correct doctrine: Carnap's intervention differs from Popperian demarcation. Correct replacement: "Carnap treats protocol form as a choice of linguistic system rather than a uniquely given foundation." - **C:** This applies an emerging tolerance attitude to observation language. - **D:** False proposition: "Carnap holds that reality fixes one uniquely correct protocol form independently of linguistic choices or pragmatic purposes." Correct doctrine: The point is explicit linguistic choice. Correct replacement: "Carnap treats protocol form as a choice of linguistic system rather than a uniquely given foundation."

Examiner trap 44: Missing the move from protocol dispute to tolerance.

Repair action: Connect protocols, language choice and tolerance.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Protocol debate; 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 45

Carnap's Principle of Tolerance means that:

A. Tolerance makes every proposition true whenever a speaker chooses a language containing it. B. Tolerance permits alternative logical languages when their rules are explicit and their adoption is pragmatically assessed. C. Tolerance converts all ethical judgements into empirically verifiable factual propositions. D. Tolerance treats logical rules as metaphysical objects discovered independently of language and binding every possible framework.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Tolerance makes every proposition true whenever a speaker chooses a language containing it." Correct doctrine: Freedom does not erase framework rules. Correct replacement: "Tolerance permits alternative logical languages when their rules are explicit and their adoption is pragmatically assessed." - **B:** Framework freedom does not erase standards of clarity or usefulness. - **C:** False proposition: "Tolerance converts all ethical judgements into empirically verifiable factual propositions." Correct doctrine: Tolerance does not factualise value. Correct replacement: "Tolerance permits alternative logical languages when their rules are explicit and their adoption is pragmatically assessed." - **D:** False proposition: "Tolerance treats logical rules as metaphysical objects discovered independently of language and binding every possible framework." Correct doctrine: Carnap treats frameworks as constructions. Correct replacement: "Tolerance permits alternative logical languages when their rules are explicit and their adoption is pragmatically assessed."

Examiner trap 45: Turning tolerance into ruleless relativism.

Repair action: State freedom plus explicit syntax plus pragmatic assessment.

Coverage mapping: C10.

MCQ 46

Carnap classifies 'Is there a prime number above 100?' and 'Are numbers really real?' respectively as:

A. Carnap treats the prime-number question as external and the reality-of-numbers question as an internal theorem. B. Carnap treats both questions as empirical problems settled by direct sensory observation. C. Carnap treats the prime-number question as internal and theoretical, and framework adoption as external and practical. D. Carnap treats both questions as meaningless because neither refers directly to physical matter.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Carnap treats the prime-number question as external and the reality-of-numbers question as an internal theorem." Correct doctrine: The labels and disciplines are reversed. Correct replacement: "Carnap treats the prime-number question as internal and theoretical, and framework adoption as external and practical." - **B:** False proposition: "Carnap treats both questions as empirical problems settled by direct sensory observation." Correct doctrine: Proof and framework choice are not ordinary reports. Correct replacement: "Carnap treats the prime-number question as internal and theoretical, and framework adoption as external and practical." - **C:** Internal questions use rules; framework adoption is assessed for utility. - **D:** False proposition: "Carnap treats both questions as meaningless because neither refers directly to physical matter." Correct doctrine: Carnap preserves internal mathematical questions. Correct replacement: "Carnap treats the prime-number question as internal and theoretical, and framework adoption as external and practical."

Examiner trap 46: Saying Carnap abolishes every existence question.

Repair action: Ask whether it is within rules or about adopting them.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q3(a).

MCQ 47

Quine's pressure on Carnap's framework distinction is strongest when he argues that:

A. Quine argues that framework choice is impossible because every meaningful language shares one invariant and unrevisable logical syntax. B. Quine argues that holism and doubts about analyticity weaken Carnap's insulated internal-external boundary. C. Quine argues that internal questions become meaningless whenever they quantify over abstract entities. D. Quine argues that Carnap's tolerance principle entails Kant's doctrine of the synthetic a priori.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Quine argues that framework choice is impossible because every meaningful language shares one invariant and unrevisable logical syntax." Correct doctrine: He does not deny linguistic variation. Correct replacement: "Quine argues that holism and doubts about analyticity

weaken Carnap's insulated internal-external boundary." - **B:** Quine treats ontology as continuous with revision of total theory. - **C:** False proposition: "Quine argues that internal questions become meaningless whenever they quantify over abstract entities." Correct doctrine: Quine accepts quantified ontological commitment. Correct replacement: "Quine argues that holism and doubts about analyticity weaken Carnap's insulated internal-external boundary." - **D:** False proposition: "Quine argues that Carnap's tolerance principle entails Kant's doctrine of the synthetic a priori." Correct doctrine: Tolerance is conventionalist, not Kantian. Correct replacement: "Quine argues that holism and doubts about analyticity weaken Carnap's insulated internal-external boundary."

Examiner trap 47: Saying Quine disproves Carnap without naming the seam.

Repair action: Link analyticity, holism and ontological commitment.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q3(a); Quine comparison.

MCQ 48

The self-application objection says that the verification principle:

A. The principle is neither analytic nor empirically verifiable and therefore fails its own criterion. B. The principle is empirically false because one decisive experiment directly refuted it. C. The principle is an analytic tautology whose denial produces a formal contradiction. D. The principle is simply another formulation of the logical law of non-contradiction.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Applied reflexively, it seems to classify itself as excluded. - **B:** False proposition: "The principle is empirically false because one decisive experiment directly refuted it." Correct doctrine: The objection concerns criterion status. Correct replacement: "The principle is neither analytic nor empirically verifiable and therefore fails its own criterion." - **C:** False proposition: "The principle is an analytic tautology whose denial produces a formal contradiction." Correct doctrine: Its denial is coherent, so the principle cannot simply be declared a tautology. Correct replacement: "The principle is neither analytic nor empirically verifiable and therefore fails its own criterion." - **D:** False proposition: "The principle is simply another formulation of the logical law of non-contradiction." Correct doctrine: It is a substantive meaning proposal. Correct replacement: "The principle is neither analytic nor empirically verifiable and therefore fails its own criterion."

Examiner trap 48: Stopping after the famous objection.

Repair action: Add the proposal reply and its cost.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2025 Q3(b).

MCQ 49

If verification is defended as a recommendation for using 'meaningful', the immediate cost is that:

- A. The recommendation avoids direct self-refutation without gaining power to compel rival linguistic practices. B. The recommendation becomes an empirically verified law describing actual speaker behaviour. C. The recommendation proves metaphysical claims false rather than cognitively meaningless. D. The recommendation becomes a Neurathian protocol report of a present observation.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** A recommendation may guide inquiry but loses universal tribunal status. - **B:** False proposition: "The recommendation becomes an empirically verified law describing actual speaker behaviour." Correct doctrine: A normative proposal is not thereby empirical. Correct replacement: "The recommendation avoids direct self-refutation without gaining power to compel rival linguistic practices." - **C:** False proposition: "The recommendation proves metaphysical claims false rather than cognitively meaningless." Correct doctrine: The reply weakens condemnation; it does not falsify metaphysics. Correct replacement: "The recommendation avoids direct self-refutation without gaining power to compel rival linguistic practices." - **D:** False proposition: "The recommendation becomes a Neurathian protocol report of a present observation." Correct doctrine: Policy and protocol reporting differ. Correct replacement: "The recommendation avoids direct self-refutation without gaining power to compel rival linguistic practices."

Examiner trap 49: Treating the proposal reply as cost-free.

Repair action: Write coherent escape, polemical disarmament.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Criticism across PYQs.

MCQ 50

Why do statements about the past create a problem for strict verificationism?

- A. Past-tense claims are analytic because calendars and dates are linguistic conventions. B. Present records make past events directly observable by reproducing their original circumstances. C. Past-tense claims are necessarily metaphysical because their events no longer occur. D. Present traces can support past claims indirectly, and present evidence is not identical with the past event described.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Past-tense claims are analytic because calendars and dates are linguistic conventions." Correct doctrine: Historical occurrence is contingent. Correct replacement: "Present traces can support past claims indirectly, and present evidence is not identical with the past event described." - **B:** False proposition: "Present records make past events directly observable by reproducing their original circumstances." Correct doctrine: The event is no longer present. Correct replacement: "Present traces can support past claims indirectly, and present evidence is not identical with the past event described." - **C:** False proposition: "Past-tense claims are necessarily metaphysical because their events no

longer occur." Correct doctrine: Weak evidence retains many historical claims. Correct replacement: "Present traces can support past claims indirectly, and present evidence is not identical with the past event described." - **D**: The claim concerns an event while verification uses current traces.

Examiner trap 50: Assuming weak evidence removes every semantic issue.

Repair action: Separate current evidence from past content.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Strong/weak criticism.

MCQ 51

The other-minds problem pressures verificationism because:

A. Other minds are analytic entities introduced by convention into a public language. B. Every speaker directly observes the private experiences of every other person. C. Popper's falsifiability criterion makes private mental-state claims both unscientific and meaningless by definition. D. Behaviour supplies public evidence for another mind and may not preserve the full claim about experience.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A**: False proposition: "Other minds are analytic entities introduced by convention into a public language." Correct doctrine: Their existence is not tautological. Correct replacement: "Behaviour supplies public evidence for another mind and may not preserve the full claim about experience." - **B**: False proposition: "Every speaker directly observes the private experiences of every other person." Correct doctrine: First- and third-person access differ. Correct replacement: "Behaviour supplies public evidence for another mind and may not preserve the full claim about experience." - **C**: False proposition: "Popper's falsifiability criterion makes private mental-state claims both unscientific and meaningless by definition." Correct doctrine: Popperian demarcation addresses scientific status, whereas meaning and evidence for other minds are separate questions. Correct replacement: "Behaviour supplies public evidence for another mind and may not preserve the full claim about experience." - **D**: Public behaviour supplies evidence but may not equal experience.

Examiner trap 51: Assuming behavioural evidence equals mental content.

Repair action: Distinguish access from reductive identity.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Strong/weak criticism.

MCQ 52

Popper's falsifiability differs from verificationism because it is offered as:

A. Falsifiability distinguishes scientific from non-scientific theories without declaring all metaphysics meaningless. B. Falsifiability requires conclusive positive proof before a general law counts as scientific. C. Falsifiability is an analytic convention that converts metaphysical systems into sciences. D. Falsifiability is the Vienna Circle's unanimous definition of protocol statements and their relation to universal scientific laws.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Popper changes the target from meaning to scientific status. - **B:** False proposition: "Falsifiability requires conclusive positive proof before a general law counts as scientific." Correct doctrine: Falsifiability rejects conclusive inductive proof. Correct replacement: "Falsifiability distinguishes scientific from non-scientific theories without declaring all metaphysics meaningless." - **C:** False proposition: "Falsifiability is an analytic convention that converts metaphysical systems into sciences." Correct doctrine: He excludes unfalsifiable systems from science. Correct replacement: "Falsifiability distinguishes scientific from non-scientific theories without declaring all metaphysics meaningless." - **D:** False proposition: "Falsifiability is the Vienna Circle's unanimous definition of protocol statements and their relation to universal scientific laws." Correct doctrine: Popper was not a Circle member. Correct replacement: "Falsifiability distinguishes scientific from non-scientific theories without declaring all metaphysics meaningless."

Examiner trap 52: Calling falsifiability weak verification.

Repair action: Write DEMARCATION, not MEANING.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q3(b); 2026 Q4(c).

MCQ 53

Which comparison best captures Quine and later Wittgenstein as bounded critics?

A. Quine defends strong verification, and later Wittgenstein formalises Carnap's logical syntax. B. Quine and later Wittgenstein were Circle members who authored its compromise on protocols. C. Quine and later Wittgenstein preserve one universal empirical criterion governing scientific, ethical, religious and mathematical uses. D. Quine attacks analyticity and isolated testing, and later Wittgenstein replaces one essence of meaning with plural use.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "Quine defends strong verification, and later Wittgenstein formalises Carnap's logical syntax." Correct doctrine: Quine attacks analyticity and isolated sentence-testing, whereas later Wittgenstein replaces a single criterion of meaning with plural language-use. Correct replacement: "Quine attacks analyticity and isolated testing, and later Wittgenstein replaces one essence of meaning with plural use." - **B:** False proposition: "Quine and later Wittgenstein were Circle members who authored its compromise on protocols." Correct doctrine: Neither belonged to the Circle. Correct replacement: "Quine attacks analyticity and isolated testing, and later Wittgenstein replaces one essence of meaning with plural use." - **C:** False proposition: "Quine and later Wittgenstein preserve one universal empirical criterion governing scientific, ethical, religious and mathematical uses." Correct doctrine: Their

work rejects that single essence. Correct replacement: "Quine attacks analyticity and isolated testing, and later Wittgenstein replaces one essence of meaning with plural use." - **D:** They undermine different assumptions and belong to later owners.

Examiner trap 53: Merging distinct successor critiques.

Repair action: Assign Quine to holism and Wittgenstein to use/grammar.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(c); Topic 08 cross-link.

MCQ 54

Why did the positivist attempt to make philosophy a handmaid to science and create a unified language ultimately fail?

A. The programme failed because the Circle abandoned formal logic and adopted speculative idealism. B. The programme failed because scientific laws, protocol disputes, theory-ladenness, holism and contested analyticity fragmented it. C. The programme failed because every science rejected public testing and all shared terminology. D. The programme failed because Popper verified metaphysics, disproved every universal law, and replaced logic with historical conjecture.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** False proposition: "The programme failed because the Circle abandoned formal logic and adopted speculative idealism." Correct doctrine: It retained logical analysis; failure arose within the programme. Correct replacement: "The programme failed because scientific laws, protocol disputes, theory-ladenness, holism and contested analyticity fragmented it." - **B:** The project supplied tools but no stable universal criterion or neutral reduction language. - **C:** False proposition: "The programme failed because every science rejected public testing and all shared terminology." Correct doctrine: Sciences remained empirical; total reduction proved untenable. Correct replacement: "The programme failed because scientific laws, protocol disputes, theory-ladenness, holism and contested analyticity fragmented it." - **D:** False proposition: "The programme failed because Popper verified metaphysics, disproved every universal law, and replaced logic with historical conjecture." Correct doctrine: Popper proposed falsifiability and did neither. Correct replacement: "The programme failed because scientific laws, protocol disputes, theory-ladenness, holism and contested analyticity fragmented it."

Examiner trap 54: Listing critics without reconstructing the project.

Repair action: Use programme, mechanisms, tensions, critics and legacy.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: 2026 Q4(c).